

Derryk Whitner

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Security Operations Center Operator

Security and Operations professional with experience supporting mission-critical operations through incident management, investigations, escalation coordination, and real-time operational monitoring in fast-paced environments. Proven ability to assess situations, document incidents accurately, communicate effectively with stakeholders, and support the timely resolution of operational issues. Experienced in control room operations, customer support, root cause analysis, and maintaining composure during high-pressure events, and recognized for strong analytical thinking, attention to detail, and a commitment to operational excellence and continuous improvement.

SKILLS

Core Skills: Agile / Ticketing Systems (Jira), Automation & Process Improvement, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Customer / User Support, Documentation & Reporting, Hardware & System Troubleshooting, Incident Response & Operations, Linux & Windows Environments, Log Analysis & Troubleshooting, Process Improvement & SOP Development, Production Systems Support, Quality Control & Accuracy, Root Cause Analysis & Debugging, Scripting Fundamentals (Python), Stakeholder Communication, System Testing & Issue Identification, System Testing & Validation, Ticket Handling & Issue Tracking, Time Management & Reliability

Interests: Systems design and problem-solving through game development

WORK EXPERIENCE

Tesla • Austin TX

Systems Support Operations Engineer • Full-time

Feb 2024 - Aug 2025

- Performed root cause analysis on complex system and application incidents by reviewing logs, operational data, and diagnostic information to identify failures and corrective actions.
- Supported firmware deployment and update activities on production battery systems, including secure file transfers, validation procedures, update execution, and post-installation verification.
- Utilized Linux command-line tools and SCP to access systems, transfer firmware packages, review system information, and support troubleshooting activities.
- Documented system configurations, technical findings, incident resolutions, and operational risks to support engineering and operations teams.
- Collaborated with cross-functional stakeholders to diagnose issues, maintain system availability, and coordinate technical resolutions.
- Leveraged Python-based tools, automation workflows, and AI-assisted analysis to improve troubleshooting efficiency, log analysis, and documentation processes.

Control Room Operator

Feb 2022 - Feb 2024

- Continuously monitoring the site for any abnormalities and deviations from expected operating behavior and expeditiously acting when required, as well as adjusting the control/operating mode of the system as required by the governing bodies.
- Proactively addressed and resolved cybersecurity concerns, ensuring the integrity and security of the industrial battery storage facilities.
- Escalated complex issues with detailed technical context to support faster resolution.
- Maintained detailed logs of incidents and outcomes.

Strategic Service Solutions Inc. • Oakland, California, United States

Seaport Terminal IT Field Engineer

Sep 2021 - Feb 2022

- Installed, configured, upgraded, and validated hardware components including memory (DIMMs), storage devices, peripherals, and workstation systems.
- Performed BIOS/UEFI and firmware update activities to support hardware compatibility, system stability, and device lifecycle management.
- Diagnosed and resolved hardware, software, operating system, and network issues through structured troubleshooting and root cause analysis.
- Assisted with hardware rework, component replacement, memory upgrades, and system configuration changes while maintaining operational continuity.
- Maintained accurate asset inventories, equipment records, deployment documentation, and technical service reports.

Acuitus, Inc. • San Francisco Bay Area

IT Program Systems and Networking Intern

Feb 2021 - Feb 2022

- Configured, monitored, and administered Domain Controllers, Active Directory, File and Exchange servers, DHCP, and DNS for Windows Server 2003/2008/2012/2016 platforms.
- Configured multiple complex networks according to best practices.
- Actively communicated all configurations, troubleshooting, and maintenance in organized logs.
- Troubleshot hardware and software issues in Windows and Linux environments.

CERTIFICATIONS

LE-1: Linux Essentials

Feb 2024

Linux Professional Institute [mjause324g]

Google IT Automation with Python Specialization

Aug 2022

Coursera

Google IT Support Certificate

Oct 2021

Coursera

CompTIA A+

Jan 2024 - Jan 2027

CompTIA [RVSVRC6T1JQ418WS]

Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals

May 2026

IBM SkillsBuild

EDUCATION

Western Governors University • Bachelor of Science - BS in Cloud and Network Engineering

Jul 2026

Estimated Completion: 7/2028

PROJECTS

Technical Projects

- Built, configured, upgraded, and validated multiple custom desktop systems for personal use, including CPU, memory (DDR4/DDR5), storage, BIOS configuration, operating system installation, and hardware troubleshooting.
- Performed memory upgrades and troubleshooting, including expanding a personal workstation from 32GB to 96GB RAM and validating system stability.
- Executed BIOS/UEFI flashing and firmware updates on personal systems and hardware devices while verifying compatibility, system functionality, and update success.
- Maintained Linux-based lab environments for cybersecurity training, scripting exercises, system administration practice, and troubleshooting.